

TAMBARAM

Chromepet » Pallavaram » Tambaram West » Rajakilpakkam » Mannivakkam » Guindy » Keelkattalai » Nanganallur » Guduvanchery » Hasthinapuram » Pammal » Tambaram East

Medavakkam » Srinivasa Nagar » Kathipara Junction » Kovilambakkam » Sadasivam Nagar » Potheri » Selaiyur » Sembakkam » St.Thomas Mount » Madipakkam » Urappakkam » Paranur



SEWAGE-LADEN SWD PLAGUE WEST CHROMEPET LOCALITIES

Residents of Mummoorthy Nagar and New Colony flag health risks, ineffective drainage network **P3**



WATER HYACINTH SAVES LIVES AT OTTIYAMBAKKAM QUARRY

An invasive, floating weed that is a bane of water sources, the water hyacinth is not just tolerated in the quarry but welcomed **P5**

Operate small buses from Puzhuthivakkam MRTS station

A small-bus network that manages coverage of neighbourhoods within a four-kilometre radius of the station would be hugely beneficial to commuters

GUNASEKARAN S

The extension of the MRTS railway line from Velachery to St. Thomas Mount railway station is just what the doctor ordered for the many neighbourhoods around Puzhuthivakkam Railway station. It has provided residents in these interior pockets with a quick and convenient travelling option. The full benefit of this provision can be reaped if the “last mile” is also taken care of.

These neighbourhoods are located within a radius of three to four kilometres from the Puzhuthivakkam station and a small bus network in these parts would help commuters reach the facility without much of a hassle. To say this value add would do senior citizens great service is to state the



PHOTO: JOHAN SATHYADAS J

obvious.

Here are a couple of options for MTC to mull over.

Route number 1 - Balaiah Garden to Puzhuthivakkam Railway Station- (via) Balaiah Garden-Pad-

mathy Road-Thilakar Avenue 2nd Street-Otteri Salai-Ponnamman Koil Road-Pillayar Koil-Bajanai Koil-Puzhuthivakkam bus stand.

Route number 2 - Madipakkam Bus stand to Puzhuthivakkam Rail-

way station (via) Ponniamman Koil-Otteri Salai junction-Pillaiyar koil-Bajanai Koil (Erikarrai school)-Puzhuthivakkam bus stand.

Gunasekaran S is a resident of Puzhuthivakkam

Tambaram humour club meets today

The monthly meeting of Tambaram Humourists' Forum will be held on March 29 at the Seventh Day Adventist Matriculation Higher Secondary School, GST Road, West Tambaram near LKS Gold House at 4 p.m.

A debate on the topic ‘Whether a man or a woman has a high sense of humour’ will be conducted.

For men, the topic will be presented by Archana Kannan and J. Premavathy; for women, by Kalaiyarasi Lingeshwaran and Lakshmi Sivakumar.

The debate will be moderated by Thamarai Kannan, Headmistress, Jaigopal Garodia Higher Secondary School.

Public can become a member of the club by paying a subscription fee of ₹ 100 per year. The club is more than 10 years old and meets every fourth Sunday of the month.

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Against the backdrop of poll activity, a 400-metre stretch of an arterial road in Madurapakkam panchayat under Tambaram assembly constituency presents a salute to the idea of *res publica*, which underpins India's system of governance, where citizens have a say, at least before a government is securely ensconced in the seat of power. A Republic Day initiative, it shines bright every night on this stretch in Kovilancherry

A representation of the Tricolour rises above party flags

PRINCE FREDERICK

On the campaign trail in Tamil Nadu, rhetoric is being whetted to a cutting edge, as always happens when the trail draws near the home stretch. Partisan flag-waving is taking on greater vigour. And parties are wooing citizens with the end-phase desperation of a hopeful suitor.

Amidst all of this intense activity, this 400-metre stretch of an arterial road in the outskirts of Chennai (technically in the Tambaram assembly constituency) presents a silent, but colourful reminder of the first principles underpinning India's system of governance, where citizens have a say, at least before a government is securely ensconced in the seat of power, vis-a-vis their vote.

Essentially, it is a continuing gesture honouring the idea of *res publica* (a republic serving the collective citizens' good) and the colours of the tricolour, instituted this Republic Day (January 26, 2026) in a rather offbeat manner in a local panchayat. The gesture shines bright after evenfall.

It is a 400-metre stretch of Mambakkam-Medavakkam Main Road running through Kovilancherry in Madurapakkam panchayat, part of the Tambaram assembly constituency. On January 26, the hallowed colours were "unfurled" with LED neon flexes on the lampposts in the median.

Since then, this stretch has been offering a salute to the Flag of all flags and by extension, the Indian republic. As the lamps come on, the flexes sinuously coiling up on the lamp posts come to live, transmitting a image of tricolour through lighting. The flex on one lamppost has fallen silent, but all others continue to the speak the language of patriotism.

Motorists' manifesto

If motorists passing through the stretch were asked to pen in a manifesto, they might demand that post Assembly-polls, they would want this section of the arterial road (managed by the State Highways) relaid. Due to a civic infra work, part of the road lacks bitumen topping. Besides, they would want more of the carriageway for moving vehicles than parked vehicles.

The specially lit lamp posts at Kovilancherry on Mambakkam-Medavakkam Main Road.

PHOTO: PRINCE FREDERICK

RWA submits petition about roads

Nesamani Nagar Residents' Welfare Association (NNRWA) in Perumbakkam has submitted a petition to the Tamil Nadu Rural Development and Panchayat Raj Department to lay roads in the region under the Prime Minister Gram Sadak Yojana scheme.

The scheme commits to building roads in areas that have not experienced any development work.

N. K. Raja, president of NNRWA, says, "There are many roads in the region that are yet to be laid. The Perumbakkam Village Panchayat has sent a letter stating an estimate for road laying."

The Department can secure the funds under the scheme after discussing the matter with the Prime Minister's Office in New Delhi and take up work. "The roads should be constructed in Golden Castle Layout, Perumbakkam," he added.



A road in Radha Nagar, Perumbakkam after the rains.
PHOTO: R. RAVINDRAN

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Sewage-laden SWDs plague West Chromepet localities

Residents of Mummoorthy Nagar and New Colony flag health risks, ineffective drainage network

T. ARVIND

Residents of Mummoorthy Nagar Second Street and parts of New Colony in Chromepet continue to grapple with sewage mixing in stormwater drains (SWDs), raising concerns over public health and the effectiveness of the drainage system in the area.

Officials said SWDs were laid in these localities to address frequent inundation caused by excess water discharge from the TB Sanatorium area.

However, according to social activist V. Santhanam, the original drainage design has been altered over the years.

Excess rainwater from GST Road near the Ramanjaneya Temple was earlier routed through a culvert beneath the railway line near Tambaram Sanatorium on the eastern side towards the Chitlapakkam lake.

"Following gauge conversion works, the channel beneath the railway track was lowered, obstructing the natural flow of wa-



ter," he said.

As a result, surplus water from GST Road near the Tamil Nadu Housing Board junction is diverted through stormwater drains along GST Road via 17th Cross Street in New Colony and into the drains along Mummoorthy Nagar Second Street, before eventually reaching Veeraraghavan Eri. Residents said that, apart from rainwater, sewage passes through this channel.

Choked drains

Residents say the system is failing

due to choked drains and sewage inflow.

"The stormwater drains here are clogged, and sewage mixing has become common. Even a brief spell of rain worsens the situation," Santhanam said, adding that the drains no longer serve their intended purpose.

A visit to Mummoorthy Nagar Third Street revealed similar conditions, with drains filled with sewage allegedly due to illegal discharge from nearby properties.

Flooding even after light rain



A clogged SWD at Mummoorthy Nagar in Chromepet; and (right) SWD along 14th Cross Street in New Colony, Chromepet. PHOTOS: T. ARVIND

Residents of Mummoorthy Nagar Second Street allege that unregulated discharge of water from nearby hospitals along GST Road contributes to flooding during even light rainfall.

Ananthi, a resident, pointed to watermarks on compound walls indicating the extent of flooding. "The height of the existing stormwater drains needs to be increased," she said.

Call for long-term solution

Activists have urged authorities to implement a permanent solution instead of temporary fixes. As an interim measure, they suggested diverting the existing SWD route from GST Road through 14th Cross Street in New

Colony instead of 17th Cross Street.

"The drains along 14th Cross Street appear wider and better equipped to carry larger volumes of water Veeraraghavan Eri," Santhanam said.

Residents believe such a diversion could reduce flooding in Mummoorthy Nagar and partially address the issue of sewage mixing. Long-time residents say older neighbourhoods on the western side of Chromepet have been neglected amid rapid development in the eastern parts.

They have called for better planning and execution of civic infrastructure projects to put an end to recurring issues.

Steep stairway to Chitlapakkam lake is fraught with risk

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Walkers at Chitlapakkam lake have requested the Water Resources Department (WRD) to build a proper staircase and an elevated passageway.

P. Viswanathan, convenor of the Chitlapakkam Residents' Associations' Co-ordination Committee, says that along Thirumugan Salai, the steps have concrete flooring with uneven and damaged surfaces. The staircase borders are damaged too.

As the steps are steep, people must use the railings.

"The approach area is marked with stones and is uneven, and becomes slushy and slippery after the rains," G. Mary George, a walker complained.

The pedestrians have to negotiate around 11 steps.

L. Sundararaman, president of Chitlapakkam Muthulakshmi Nagar Welfare Association, says along Chitlapakkam Third Main Road, opposite a supermarket, a senior citizen sustained a fall when negotiating down slope steps to take shelter from the rain.

The stone staircases along the bund are broken, and PVC pipes have been installed as railings. The Water Resources Department must facilitate a proper metal slope pathway in the safety of walkers at the earliest, Sundararaman added.



Selection for MUN Europe

Speak Your Mind is organising the 'MUN Europe Selection Programme' to identify students who can represent India at an international conference. The top 10 delegates will be selected to represent India at MUN Europe, scheduled to take place in Malta from October 7-9, 2026, said a release.

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‘Deploy police personnel under Medavakkam flyover’



T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

The meeting point of Classical Language Road and Velachery Main Road and its precincts in Medavakkam can at times get chaotic.

On the lane towards Pallikarai, motorists intending to proceed on the eastern lane of the Main Road (towards Madambakkam Main Road) and Classical Language Road should take a U-turn near the Medavakkam farm-

ers market. But, they drive along the Medavakkam haltover (towards Tambaram (East and West) and Kilambakkam.

Only motorists from Classical Language Road and Velachery Main Road (eastern lane) towards Pallikarai can navigate this.

“This causes congestion on Classical Language Road and Velachery Main Road,” says B. Haritha Babu, a rider.

Traffic is disrupted on Velachery Main Road, the lane towards Pallikarai, as a good

number of vehicle users wait to move in the opposite direction.

Motorists speed and swerve right and left. Motorists on Velachery Main Road, the lane towards Pallikarai, should not turn right, but when they see their counterparts taking a turn, they stop their vehicles all of a sudden to follow them. This can lead to multiple collisions on Velachery Main Road, adds Haritha.

“Traffic police personnel must be deployed here to curb this practice and prevent accidents.”



Motorists drive in the wrong direction to enter Velachery Main Road and Classical Language Road. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

READERS WRITE

Escalators needed at Chromepet railway station



P. VISWANATHAN

Southern Railway should install escalators at Chromepet railway station footbridge along Station Road, East Chromepet. At present, pedestrians have to climb a good number of steps to reach the walkway on the bridge.

The same situation prevails for commuters entraining the trains and pedestrians heading towards the region's east from the west and the Madras Institute of Technology flyover. Towards Chromepet post office, the pedestrians have to negotiate around 90 steps.

People use the footbridge to go to Chromepet haltover to go to Kalaingar Centenary Bus

Terminus in Kilambakkam.

Pedestrian and commuter traffic along Station Road and Station Border Road is frequently observed.

The facility will divide the pedestrian traffic and be a huge boon to pedestrians.

People climb over the boundary walls abutting the tracks along Station Border Road and cross the tracks to go to the platforms and through 1A, a double-discharge platform to go to GST Road.

A railway-owned vehicle parking space with safe entry and exit arrangements to the station is also the need of the hour.

P. Viswanathan is a resident of Chitlapakkam

‘Regulate this link road’



The road starting from Medavakkam to Perumbakkam/Sholinganallur Main Road (leading to Mambakkam Main Road) has become squalid and congested. Fourth Main Road in Radha Nagar, Perumbakkam, where I reside, has become unfit for walking for elders like me. This stretch is very narrow and is used by motorists travelling from Mambakkam Road to Sholinganallur Main Road.

This road has to be regulated by being made as one-way by installation of speed breakers.

R. Radhakrishnan is a resident of Perumbakkam

‘Restore the lake outlet channel’

B. SARAVANAN

The Federation of Thiruneermalai Residents' Welfare Associations' has sent a letter petition (through a mail) to the District Mineral Foundation (DMF) Trust in Chengalpattu to restore the Thiruneermalai Periya Eri outlet channel, 'Nattu Kalvai'.

As part of a desilting and deepening exercise, as per a Government Order, around 6.68 lakh cubic metres of earth was extracted, generating revenue of ₹ 12 crore.

The DMFT will use the revenue for water provisioning (as the groundwater is depleted), prioritising health, and education of people and children residing in areas surrounding the lake.

I request a sum of the revenue to be used for restoring 'Nattu Kalvai' by removing encroachments, constructing high walls, and de-silting and deepening the channel (to prevent water flow into residential areas during the monsoon).

The areas include Saraswathipuram, Saraswathipuram Extension,

Ranga Nagar, Kasi Garden, Subbaraya Nagar, Temple Town, and Jain Housing.

Apart from that, sewage treatment plants should be facilitated along the outlet channel and treated water must be discharged into the channel. Or an underground drainage scheme should be implemented in the area.

Revetment walls should be built across the bunds to prevent soil erosion along the water-holding area, and to prevent the soil erosion water running into Thiruneermalai Road.

B. Saravanan is treasurer of the Federation of Thiruneermalai Residents' Welfare Associations'

Water hyacinth saves lives at Ottiyambakkam quarry

The Ottiyambakkam panchayat had a harrowingly difficult time keeping people from swimming in the deadly quarry with its protruding rocks hidden under the waters. There had been many deaths. And then nature intervened, and the fatal accidents stopped. An invasive, floating weed that is a bane of water sources, the water hyacinth is not just tolerated in the quarry but welcomed



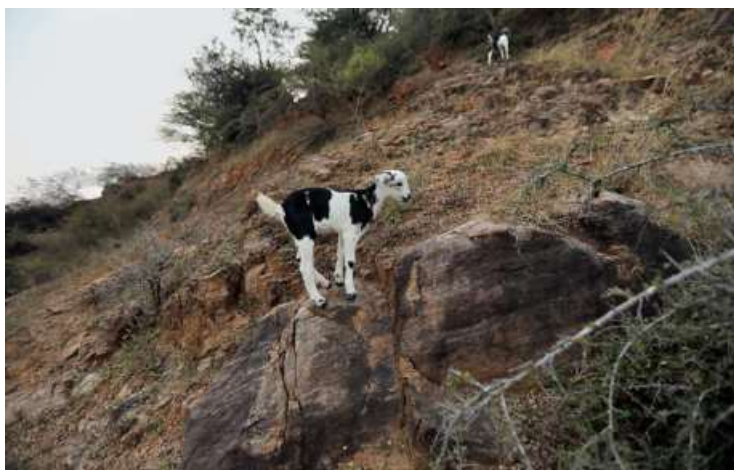
▼ The waters at the abandoned quarry in Ottiyambakkam overrun with water hyacinth, which serves as a life saver in this context; the street along the quarry marked by a row of saplings now; a goat kid on the flanks; and an expansion project pertaining to a temple on the summit of the hillock that constitutes the abandoned quarry. The images were taken on March 21, 2026. PHOTOS: PRINCE FREDERICK

PRINCE FREDERICK

What you see in Ottiyambakkam is straight out of Lawley Road in R.K. Narayan's delectably imaginary, pint-sized but variegated universe, Malgudi. In a post-Independence, post-colonial environment, efforts to recast roads in a native mould, specifically their names, a populist obsession that continues to this very day and minute, reach Malgudi with Sir Frederick Lawley's statue being removed intact from Lawley Road before the renaming of the thoroughfare. After the statue is lifted off its footings (in fact, blasted with dynamite, safely though), fresh information about Lawley's immense contribution to Malgudi's growth surfaces, causing a change of heart. The mood now shifts to: Lawley Road should continue as Lawley Road and the British official's life-size statue live on in Malgudi.

Superimpose that idea upon the abandoned Ottiyambakkam quarry, where a carpet of green woven with water hyacinth spreads across the waters.

Water hyacinth, an antagonist in water sources everywhere, plays a do-gooder role in the Ottiyambakkam quarry alone. Detested and met with calls for its removal in lakes and waterways, in the waters of the abandoned Ottiyambakkam



quarry the water hyacinth has found a home where it is not just tolerated but welcomed.

Here is how the water hyacinth stepped into this new role.

Of the abandoned quarries in and around Chennai, the one in Ottiyambakkam is probably the most diminutive, and decidedly the most dangerous. A magnet for ad-

venture seekers, the quarry has witnessed many revellers accidentally dash their heads against the jutting crags hidden waters while diving in for a swim. Accessible via what is called Mount Street, this quarry was a source of headache for the local Ottiyambakkam panchayat, its many warning boards yelling at these adventure seekers to stay off these waters, but the harsh warning was being received with leaden ears. The fatal accidents continued, and then it stopped due to an unexpected turn of events. The warning boards have gone, having become glaringly redundant.

What the warnings and monitoring by the local civic body could not achieve was managed silently by a quirky act of nature. For quite some time now the quarry has been unusable by weekend revellers for swimming and by local residents for cloth-washing, thanks to a proliferation of water hyacinth. How long this quarry is in a state where water hyacinth has covered the entire expanse of the waters depends on the lips commenting on it. A small time trader in these parts thinks it should be nearly two years, if not more.

The floating water hyacinth is an invasive species and its spread has a deleterious effect on water sources, and the living organisms in them. It is definitely a problem to be dealt with wherever it is found,

but certainly not in the Ottiyambakkam quarry. If one does a cost-benefit analysis (the benefits being lives saved), leaving the water hyacinth alone and thriving would be a judicious idea. At the foot of the half-cut hillock, on the street, saplings encased in tree guards stand. They are pleasant substitutes for the warning boards that were hollering in vain.

The rear section of the hillock, the uncut portion, is as busy as ever, as it holds a temple in the crook of its palm. A winding cement road leading up to the temple is accustomed to the brush of feet and tyres, both in units of two and four. Cars sweep effortlessly to the summit. People mill around the surface of the hillock, so do livestock. On the flanks, expect to watch a tennis-ball cricket match being played on, rough uneven ground, the ball bouncing off boulders. A straight on the winding cement road serves as pitch. There is movement of livestock, particularly goats feeding on the vegetation on the flanks of the hillock. The surface area of the temple at the summit being increased through an expansion project, long blocks of stones have been stationed and they are in different stages of carving.

From the summit, the sight of the setting, orangish sun hovering over the hillocks in Kumizhi and surrounding areas in the west is arresting.

The *swap* code

This has nothing to do with computer programming, but with an initiative that encourages participants to consider doing a swap on household items that might have outgrown their home but still has a place in somebody else's. Welcome to three online groups started by sustainability enthusiast and volunteer Swathi Ramanathan

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

Perfectly usable furniture, electronic goods, utensils and books often end up discarded because households have outgrown them. While volunteering for waste collection drives Kasturba Nagar resident Swathi Ramanathan regularly came across this anomaly and felt prompted to start two online groups, both with a WhatsApp and Telegram presence, that encourage swapping over shopping, wherever that is possible, and give gently used household items and books a new address where they are cherished all over again. In addition, following a discussion in one of these swap groups, she also formed a group where participants can learn about free wellness programmes much before they are rolled out.

Swap Don't Shop

At last count, around 1,500 residents of Chennai follow that imperative, always asking themselves whether they can swap and not shop. A WhatsApp-based initiative that spilled over to Telegram, the group enables swapping of household goods. Born on 15 July 2024 in WhatsApp, where it has hit the ceiling being packed with 1025 members, Swap Don't Shop has had to find an additional home in Telegram, where it commands the following of over 500 members. The author of the initiative, Kasturba Nagar resident Swathi Ramanathan, felt the need for this group while coordinating waste collection drives as a volunteer of Residents of Kasturba Nagar Association (ROKA). During these drives, she repeatedly noticed items still in good condition being discarded. "We saw many usable household items being thrown away. We believe a product has to be used till its lifetime comes to an end," says Swathi. Initially launched as a clothes exchange group by Swathi along with Vaishnavi Venkatesh, the platform was later expanded to include all household items after the early model failed to gain traction.

Transactions follow clear guidelines: only household items without expiry dates are allowed, and plants are welcomed. Members post photos with detailed descriptions, including brand, age, dimensions, condition, price, and pickup location. Delivery is coordinated directly between

buyer and seller, occasionally involving porters for larger items. The platform has enabled beneficiaries ranging from domestic help needing textbooks and study guides to expatriates seeking short-term household items like Golu dolls. While logistical challenges, pricing issues, and trust concerns occasionally arise, Swathi believes the initiative finds itself sustained by a sense of community and purpose felt by members.

Chennai Book Bridge

Chennai Book Bridge is a Diwali gift to those who still swear by the physical book, while also consuming information digitally. Again, the idea of starting this group occurred to Swathi during waste collection drives. She came across many people who wanted to part with their books, but only with those who will cherish those books. She decided on starting a book-swapping WhatsApp group, which has now grown to nearly 300 members, most of whom are senior citizens and regular readers who prefer physical books. Beyond book exchange and donations, the group encourages discussions on authors, genres, literary events, and book-to-film adaptations, creating an interactive reading community. Swathi notes that these discussions have become a defining feature. "It is a lovely group... there are so many things I myself didn't know about authors and books," she says.

Although a Telegram version was introduced to organise discussions by genre, participation remains stronger on WhatsApp due to the older user base. Challenges, such as reselling low-value books or managing occasional rude behaviour, are moderated with clear guidelines emphasising good faith. Swathi elaborates, "We cannot control everything, but we ensure the platform remains respectful and focused on reading."

Nalam Chennai Wellness Connect

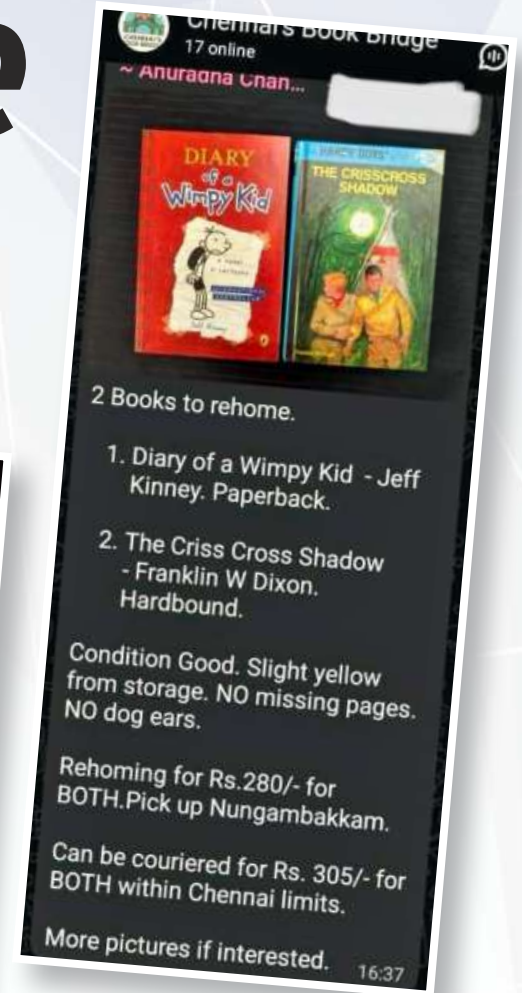
Free wellness camps have a way of eluding timely notice. Often times, they come to light as a post-event report in a website or a newspaper. Nalam Chennai Wellness Connect, present on WhatsApp and Telegram group, is an effort to bring visibility to free wellness programmes (yoga classes, health camps and so on) much before they start rolling so that people can attend and benefit from

them. Free yoga classes, free health camps

The idea began as an offshoot of the Swap Don't Shop initiative. "We wanted to brainstorm with participants about their interests. One of the interests was the wellness group. They said they wanted to know more about what was happening in the city in terms of wellness."

Members themselves can share details of free wellness services, provided the information is authentic. Swathi has shared updates on government initiatives, like free HPV vaccinations for adolescents. Currently, the group has 87 members on WhatsApp and 21 on Telegram, forming a small but growing network connecting Chennai residents to wellness opportunities that won't cost them a rupee.

For joining any of these groups, contact Swathi Ramanathan at 93812 02054



Mega career counselling fair on April 11 and 12

Conducted by
The Hindu EducationPlus,
the fair is in its
23rd edition

The *Hindu EducationPlus* is conducting the 23rd edition of The Hindu EducationPlus Career Counselling Fair 2026 on April 11 and 12 from 10 a.m. to 6 p.m. at the Chennai Trade Centre, Convention Hall.

The exhaustive fair for parents and students from classes 9 to 12 will empower aspiring young minds to make informed career decisions from 40 plus institutions and help them choose the right courses and colleges. Top educational and financial institutions from across India will be present. Furthermore, career guidance sessions with domain experts will help people dis-



cuss their career plans.

This annual fair is a great chance for students and parents to explore different career paths, learn about college admissions, and gain insights into various fields of

study.

A plethora of options awaits students as they get ready to finish their schooling, much more than ever before. There is a wide range of courses to choose from,



REPRESENTATIONAL PICTURE

careers to aspire to, and areas of interest to delve into. In every edition, the fair has aimed to give students insights into several areas, cater to their interests, and open a world of educational opportunities for them.

The latest edition of the career Counselling fair will have all of this and make this experience possible for students by giving them the platform to engage with experts across diverse fields and representatives from various educational and financial institutions. Keeping up with the needs of the students, *The Hindu Education-*

Plus has been organising career expos to aid students looking to pursue higher education both in India and overseas.

Spot admissions and scholarships await the students at the fair along with surprise gifts for the first 200 entries on both the days. To know more about the sessions and the fair, contact: +91 90940 41021, 9962226550 and 9841298938.

"VIT Chennai presents The Hindu - Education Plus Career Counselling Fair 2026" is powered by Hindustan Group of Institutions,

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To register: <https://newsth.live/THEPCFCD> or scan the QR code:



Tiny tots graduate



Sujay Public School in Vadakkupattu Main Road, Medavakkam, celebrated its seventh graduation day for its senior kindergarten students. Chief guest was Rajarajeswari Shankar, founder and director of Sixsenses Child Development Centre, principal of GEN-B Preschool. Chairman M. Vijayakumar; and correspondent V. Muhilkumar, trustee V. Subbulakshmi took part. Dressed in vibrant graduation robes and caps, little graduates sparkled with confidence and talent, said a release.

The Alumni Association of Sri Venkateswara College of Engineering (SVCE), Sriperumbudur, hosted the second edition of its Annual Alumni Awards at Taj Wellington Mews in Chennai. The event brought together over 150 alumni from India and abroad, reflecting the global reach of the SVCE community, says a press release.

Organised by alumni, for alumni, the Annual Alumni Awards recognises achievements across sectors.

In this edition, Lifetime Achievement Awards were presented to Air Vice Mar-

SVCE alumni awards presented



shal R Guruhari, recipient of the Vishisht Seva Medal (2026) and Bala V. Sathyanarayanan, EVP & CHRO - Greif, USA & Board Chairman, Balmer Lawrie-Van Leer Limited.

Awards were also presented across categories in-

From the event.

cluding Professional Excellence, Entrepreneurship Excellence, Young Alumni, Alumni Community Builder and Nation Builder, the release adds. "This event reflects the strength of our alumni network. We aim to bring together over 25,000 SVCE graduates," said Vijay Gnanadesikan, president of the SVCE Alumni Association.

Rotary Club of Chennai Tower, a unit of Rotary International District 3233, organised its annual vocational service award event recently.

According to a press release, N Silambarasan, better known as "Silambam Silambu" from Ponneri was presented with Vocational Service Award - Young Achiever in Sports in recognition of his expertise in martial art, Silambam.

The Vocational Service Award - Social Service was presented to Selvakumar, a tailor from Virudhunagar. He has trained a large number of underprivileged women in tailoring with an aim to empower them for a fee

Vocational awards presented



of ₹1.

S Padma, a 48-year-old conservancy worker from Chennai was presented with Vocational Service Award - Epitome of Ethics Icon for the prompt return of 45 sovereigns of gold jewellery that she discovered

during her duty. The award aims to honour her exceptional honesty.

Nimal Raghavan, an engineer-turned-environmentalist, was honoured for his work on conservation of lakes. He was presented with Vocational Service

Award - Environmental Preservation.

Vocational Service Award - Lifetime Achievement was presented to Bharatanatyam exponent Leela Samson, adds the release.

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